

DJI Phantom 3

The year of the drone

DJI have been making drones for a few years now and seem to have made a name for themselves when it comes to developing video shooting drones. Their latest \$1300 offering is the DJI Phantom 3 Professional and it shoots 4K video and more. The kit is pretty standard at first glance. There's 4K video, at 24 or 30 fps, 1080p video at up to 60 fps, gimbals to keep the camera steady and four rotors to take it up to speeds of 56 kmph. What's really unique about the Phantom 3 is the fact that it can be used indoors without breaking the rotors or hurting your cat. Using an ultrasound ground-facing positioning system and cameras, the Phantom 3 can identify what it's flying over. Inside is a 1/2.3" Sony sensor and can shoot 12 MP still images. This is the same sensor that DJI use on their professional grade drone, the DJI Inspire 1. The only catch here though is the fact that the camera on the Phantom 3 can't be removed. Unlike the GoPro and its 170 degree angle of view, the Phantom 3 only features a 94 degree FOV. While this may seem narrower, the plus side is that the footage will have much less distortion and still manage to capture a good chunk of what's ahead.

The Phantom 3 comes with a controller to which you can attach your smartphone or tablet. While the Phantom 3's movements can be controlled with the remote, the smartphone or tablet can be used to



view the video footage and make more adjustments to the Phantom 3's flight using the DJI app.

If you're willing to forgo the 4K, there's a cheaper Phantom 3 Advanced that you can pick up for about \$300 less. Both models also come with a nifty feature that makes them automatically land from where they took off in case the battery runs out. No more dive bombing drones then!

SPECIFICATIONS

Sensor: 1/2.3-inch CMOS with 3-axis gimbal head | **Top Speed:** 53 kmph | **Battery:** 4480 mAh Li-ion | **Battery life:** 23 minutes of flight
Price: \$1000 and \$1260 (₹62,000 to ₹78,500)

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